wttr.in — Console Weather Service

Console Oriented Services

Igor Chubin

wttrin-curlup-talk

curl up Talk 2026

Timeline

2015–2016 — Started as a small wrapper to demonstrate the idea of console services
2017 — Initial growth in popularity
2017 — Presented at curl up 2017
2018 — Introduction of new features and views (V2, V3, one-line format etc)
2019 — curlator framework presented at curl up
2020 — Reached 10M+ daily queries
2026 — Reached 100M+ daily queries

Some metrics:

- **29.7k** Github Stars
- **74** languages
- **200+** contributors (mostly translators)

Timeline



Core Concept

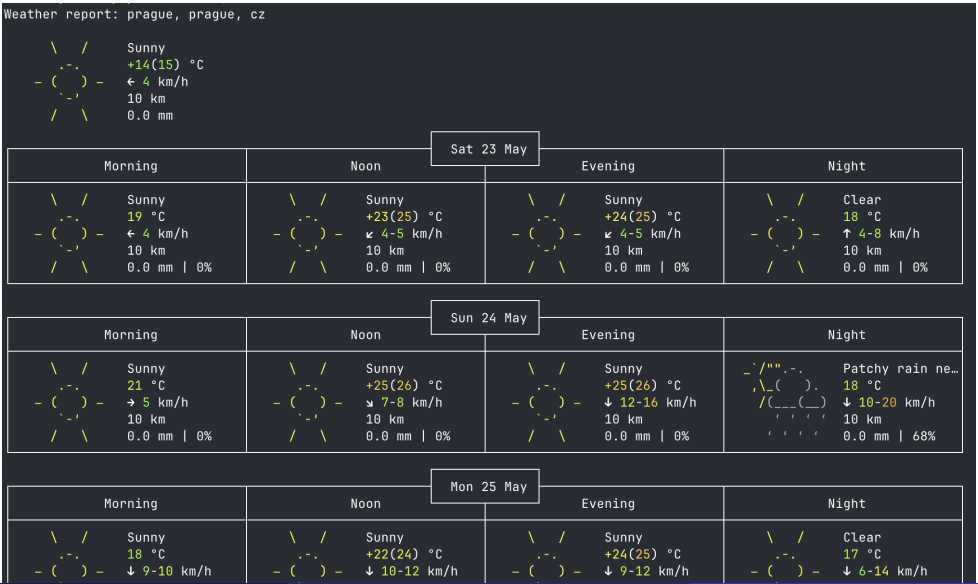
wttr.in is a **console-oriented weather forecast service** that returns beautiful, human-readable output directly in your terminal.

```
curl wttr.in                    # Auto-detects location by IP
curl wttr.in/London             # Specific city
curl wttr.in/Eiffel+Tower       # Landmarks
curl fr.wttr.in/Paris           # Localized output
```

Key Features:

- Automatic terminal capability detection (ANSI colors, width)
- Rich ASCII art icons
- Multiple output formats: ANSI, HTML, PNG

V1 — Standard View



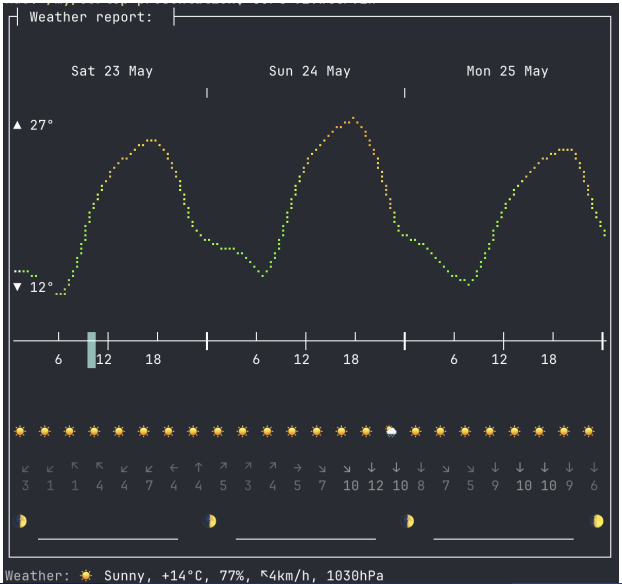
V2 — Rich Data Format

```
curl v2.wttr.in/London
```

New in V2:

- Detailed hourly forecasts
- Moon phases (today + next 3 days)
- Astronomical data (dawn, sunrise, sunset, dusk)
- Precise coordinates and timezone
- Structured output perfect for scripting

V2 — Rich Data Format



Oneline Mode

Perfect for **status bars, tmux, shell prompts**, and scripts.

```
curl wttr.in/?format=1
curl wttr.in/?format=3
curl wttr.in/?format=%t
```

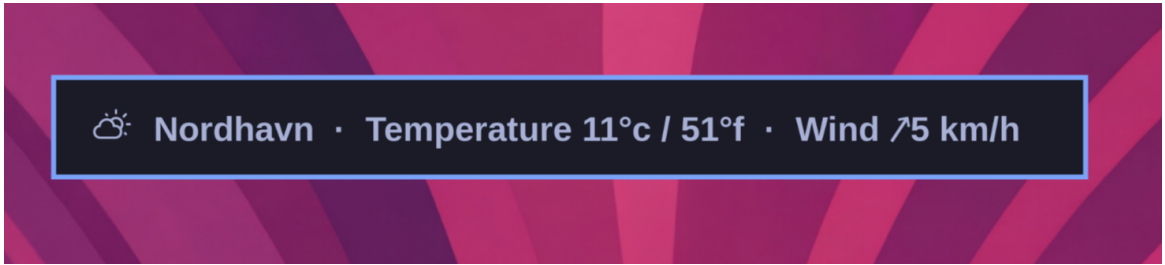
Example output:

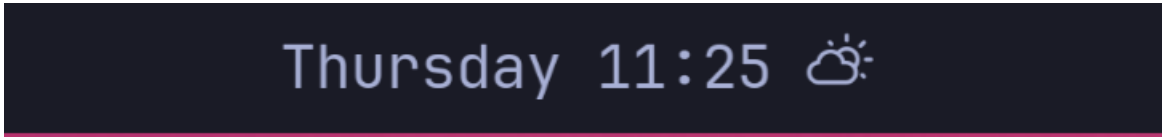
```
London: +18°C
```

Where wttr.in is Used

- Shell scripts & dotfiles
- Status bars (i3, sway, tmux, waybar, etc.)
- Linux distributives (Omarchy etc)
- Custom dashboards
- PowerShell & Windows Terminal
- Monitoring tools
- Browser shortcuts (PNG mode)
- Browser extensions

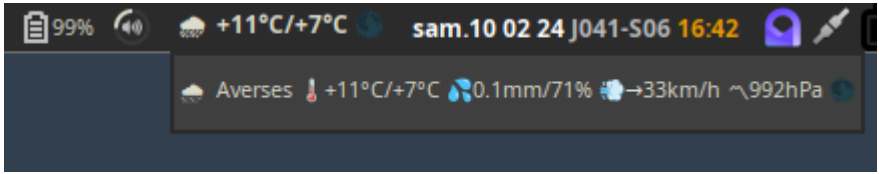
Where wttr.in is Used (Omarchy Linux uses wttr.in by default)

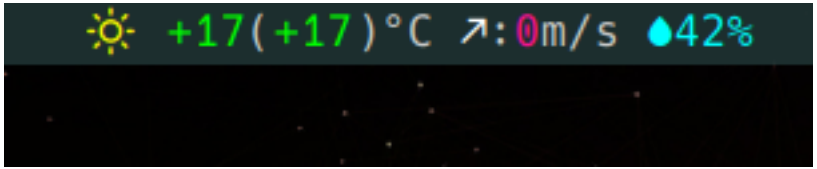




Where wttr.in is Used (tmux, AwesomeWM, Xmobar, Emacs)

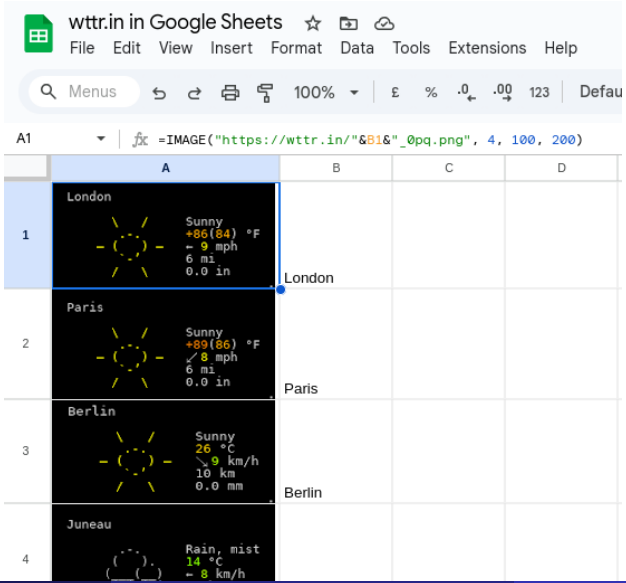








Where wttr.in is Used (can be used everywhere)



LLMs Love wttr.in

Possible weather related queries:

- `how to check weather in linux`
- `... in bash`
- `... in cli`
- `... in shell`
- `... in terminal`

in all major LLMs:

- `GPT-[45]*` from OpenAI
- `Gemini` from Google
- `Grok` from xAI
- `DeepSeek`
- etc

Lists of Agents and wttr.in

These projects commonly use wttr.in as a lightweight weather skill or tool within their agent capabilities:

- openclaw
- QuantClaw
- picobot
- microclaw
- nanobot
- openakita
- devclaw
- openpaw
- debot
- cortez
- rayclaw
- acpclaw
- ...

and many others.

Hello World for skills

wttr.in is typically used to explain the notion of a skill to the user.

Example from **picobot** README:

```
## Skills System

Teach your agent new tricks. Skills are modular knowledge packages that extend
the agent:

---
You: "Create a skill for checking weather using curl wttr.in"
Agent: Created skill "weather" - I'll use it from now on.
---

Skills are just markdown files in ~/.picobot/workspace/skills/.
Create them via the agent or manually.
```

Current Traffic

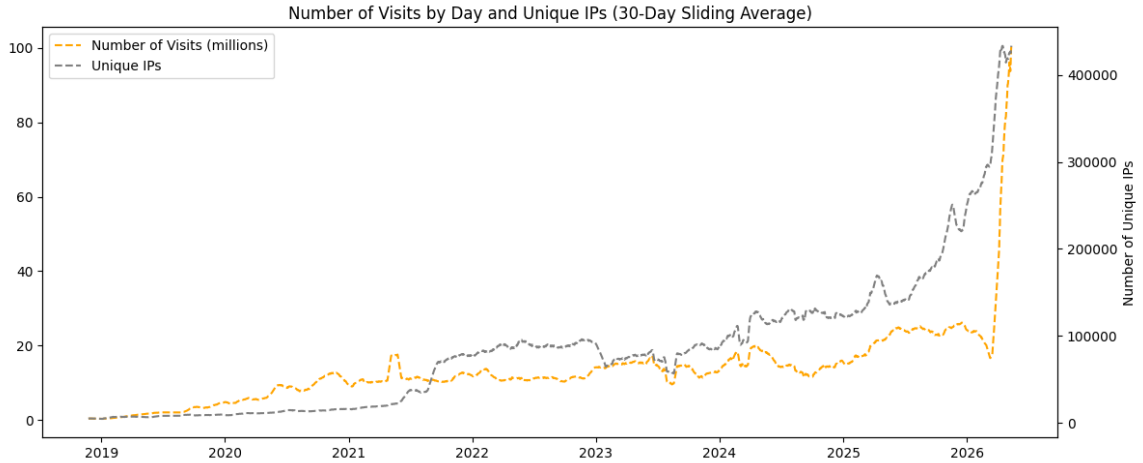


Figure 5: wttr.in Usage Statistics

Current Traffic

- ~100 million queries per day (sliding 30 day average)
- 400,000 – 450,000 unique users daily (sliding 30 day average)
- Up to 800,000 users in the peak days
- Up to 200 million queries in the peak days
- Strong and continuous growth

To put it into perspective:

- curl.se (fastly) serves 118B/year ~ 300M/daily

LLMs Love wttr.in

Console-First Design = Agent-Friendly

It is one of the most **agent-friendly** weather services:

- Zero setup — just a simple `GET` request
- Simple and consistent URL structure
- No API keys required
- Clean, predictable, human-readable output
- No bloat, returns exactly the data needed

This philosophy aligns perfectly with how modern AI coding/terminal agents operate:

- They live in terminals.
- They use curl, wget, or simple HTTP clients.
- They prefer text interfaces over JSON-heavy APIs.

curlator — Framework for building console-oriented web services

Philosophy: > The web should be friendly to `curl` users.

Converts Linux/CLI/Terminal programs or APIs into console services.

Used by:

- **wttr.in** – weather service
- **cheat.sh** – the only cheat sheet you need
- **rate.sx** – cryptocurrency exchange rates
- others

More services at:

- https://github.com/chubin/ – my services
- https://github.com/chubin/awesome-console-services – other console services

curlt — Terminal Extension for curl

curlt is a **drop-in replacement / wrapper** for `curl` that adds rich terminal context to every request.

It enables console services (like wttr.in) to **adapt their output** intelligently to the client's environment.

Headers Sent by curlt (`X-Curlt-` prefix)

Header	Description	Example
`X-Curlt-Lang`	Language / Locale	`en_US.UTF-8`
`X-Curlt-Terminal`	Terminal type & capabilities	`xterm-256color`
`X-Curlt-Columns`	Terminal width	`120`
`X-Curlt-Lines`	Terminal height	`38`
`X-Curlt-Attached`	Is terminal attached / interactive?	`true` / `false`
`X-Curlt-Image`	Preferred Image Protocol	`sixel`

```
# Direct usage
curlt wttr.in/London
```

Thank You!

`curl wttr.in`

Useful Links:

- GitHub: github.com/chubin/wttr.in
- Alternative domain: `wttr.is`

Long live curl!